UFACTORY Lite 6

Funding: US$ 396,247 pledged of US$ 50,000 goal
Link: https://digit.in/ufactorylite6

If you are scouring the market for a programmable robotic arm to help with your business' production line, the UFACTORY Lite 6 Robotic Arm is an affordable option that is now available on Kickstarter at a starting price of 1,199 USD. Equipped with six axes, the UFACTORY Lite 6 is an ideal robotic arm for repetitive, monotonous tasks. Manual tasks can be easily automated using this robot and it can even be customised to meet an individual lab's needs. The Lite 6 is supported on Windows, Mac, iOS, Linux and Android platforms and can be programmed using Python ROS and C++ depending on the application. The robotic arm has a max speed of 500mm/s and a 1kg payload. A few examples of applications it can be used for are touchscreen testing, coffee machine operation, and machine tending. The robot is designed out of carbon fibre allegedly making it 50 per cent lighter than other robotic arms in the market. It is designed for 24/7 working with its inbuilt absolute encoder and FOC control algorithm that helps create smooth movement. The arm can be programmed using the free UFACTORY Studio software.

xTool M1

Funding: US$ 939,931 pledged of US$ 100,000 goal
Link: https://digit.in/xtoolm1

DIY enthusiasts, take notice! Makeblock's xTool M1 is an all-in-one desktop hybrid laser and blade cutting machine that allows users to bring their creative designs to life. The company is marketing it as the first-ever desktop hybrid laser cutter/engraver and blade cutter. The machine makes it simple to design products on a PC and then use the cutting machine to manufacture it like with a 3D printer. The machine comes packing both laser and blade heads to facilitate all types of cutting. For example, a laser cutter usually performs well with materials such as wood, metal and glass. However, it is not as efficient with softer materials such as vinyl. This is where blade cutting comes in and it can be used to make DIY T-shirts, logos, and more. The company claims you can make all kinds of items including clothes, mugs, jewellery, toys, and more. You can even engrave glasses, knives and food items such as macarons! The xTool M1 is also affordable unlike co2 powered laser cutters on the market that cost up to several thousand dollars. The xTool M1 uses a diode laser and a utilised FAC lens to bring down the costs. The 5W variant is available on Kickstarter at an Early Bird price of 699 USD.

PiBox

Funding: US$ 118,489 pledged of US$ 50,000 goal
Link: https://digit.in/pibox

Created by Kubesail based in San Francisco, the PiBox is a purpose-built NAS (storage server) designed for running self-hosted applications at your home or office. It is a modular Raspberry Pi storage server that runs self-hosted applications all day but uses minimal power. Being modular, it allows you to add any two SATA compatible SSDs of your choice. The PiBox is powered by the Raspberry Pi Compute Module 4 and the standard bundle includes 8GB of RAM, 8GB of built-in storage, and Wi-Fi. Additionally, the PiBox also houses a microSD card slot, so you can even run 'Lite' variants without any onboard storage without a hitch. The PiBox also comes equipped with a 1.3-inch LCD display, an external Wi-Fi antenna, a Noctua 5 V PWM fan, and more, all enclosed in a small steel enclosure. Users can also add sensors and Pi HATs for increased functionality. The PiBox is powered by Kubesail that allows for easy installation or migration of apps and web hosting services. As mentioned above, all the components within the PiBox are completely modular and upgradable, and you can also buy a DIY edition instead that only provides the carrier and backplane boards, allowing the user to build the rest. The standard bundle of the PiBox is priced starting at 250 USD while the hacker bundle (DIY edition) is priced starting at 100 USD.